

BarberRepublic

EARN . LIVE . THRIVE | The labour exchange platform for the barbering industry

Introduction for Haatch | Submitted via introduction from Graham Byrne | Prepared by John Webb O'Rourke, Commercial Lead | July 2026
| Confidential

The Problem

The UK barbering industry is worth over £1 billion a year, and it runs on a structural inefficiency nobody has solved. Every barbershop is two barbers away from serious trouble. A holiday, a sick day, or a barber simply taking a day off means empty chairs and lost revenue that cannot be recovered.

At the same time, many self-employed and contract barbers experience quieter trading days. As consumer behaviour continues to change, peak trading days differ from one shop to another, creating unused capacity in some locations while others struggle to meet demand.

BarberRepublic bridges that gap by allowing skilled barbers to move between locations, helping shop owners maximise revenue while giving barbers the opportunity to earn more consistently throughout the month.

The Solution

BarberRepublic is the labour exchange platform for the barbering industry. Barbers post their available days and day rate. Shops post their open chairs. The platform intelligently matches them in minutes. Both sides confirm, the barber shows up, the work gets done, payment goes through the app. Both sides rate the experience. Simple. Fast. Done.

The platform is AI-native by design — intelligent matching, demand prediction and platform learning are built in from the ground up under the direction of an AI systems architect regarded among the top 2% of AI builders globally. Every booking improves the model, building a proprietary data layer a standard booking app cannot replicate. Four skill tiers — Barber (£120+) through Super Pro Hair (£180+) — ensure every barber earns at their level; emergency cover commands a surge premium.

Market and Validation

The UK barbering market exceeds £1 billion in annual revenue. The market has confirmed the problem is real: OpenChair launched in the United States in summer 2026 — an app allowing barbers and stylists to find and rent chairs nationwide — confirming the demand is global. No equivalent UK labour exchange platform exists. BarberRepublic is not entering an untested market; it is entering a validated one, ahead of any equivalent UK platform. The first mover window is open now.

Business Model

Revenue Stream	Description	Timing
Commission	Percentage of every booking — payable by the shop	From day one
Membership	Monthly subscriptions for barbers and shops — enhanced features and priority matching	From Month 3
Advertising	Premium barbering brands advertising to a captive professional audience in-app	Year 2 onwards
Education	Academies and educators listed and booked through the platform, commission per booking	Year 2 onwards

Progress to Date

- Platform concept fully developed and documented; app mockup completed across seven screens.

- AI-native architecture designed by the technical lead; MVP specification locked, targeted at 90 days from funding confirmation.
- Founding member strategy in motion — signed Letters of Intent being gathered, targeting 30 barbers and 15 shops for the London launch.
- In active conversation with True, a London-based consumer and retail VC, following a warm introduction. First call completed, response pending.
- Rebrand from BarberTemp to BarberRepublic under way; domain barbertemp.ai secured; formal IP protection and platform legal framework in progress.

The Team

Role	Background
Johnny Shanahan — Founder & Industry Authority	25 years as a master barber. Founder of BarberBarberUK, Manchester. Personal network across the UK, US, Australia and Japan. Trusted at the highest level of the industry. Leading the founding barber and shop recruitment personally.
John Webb O'Rourke — Commercial Lead	40 years across law, finance, property and entrepreneurship. Managing Partner, Ambrion AI and Meridian Intelligence. Commercial strategy, investor relations, legal and governance.
Technical Lead — AI Architecture	AI systems architect regarded among the top 2% of AI builders globally. Full AI-native platform architecture designed. MVP delivered by a contracted build team under his direction.

The Raise

Item	Figure	Notes
Minimum raise	£500,000	Covers Year 1 fully with runway into Year 2.
Target raise	£600k–£750k	Full Year 2 runway. No second raise before traction is confirmed.
Year 1 costs	£350,000	MD salary, COO, tech build, legal, office, launch. Zero Year 1 revenue assumed.
Revenue starts	Month 5–6	Commission from founding cohort. London only.
Break-even	Month 20–24	Monthly break-even. Stage 2 UK roll-out raise from traction.
Year 5 value (est.)	£100m–£150m	Standard 8x–12x EBITDA marketplace multiples.

BarberRepublic is raising a minimum of £500,000 to build an AI-native platform in a validated market with a founder the industry already trusts. Year 1 is treated as fully at risk with zero revenue assumed — a deliberately conservative basis. The target raise of £600,000 to £750,000 removes the pressure of a second raise before London traction is firmly established and gives the business the best chance of reaching break-even on its own terms.

Expansion Roadmap

Phase	Period	Geography	Objective
1 — Proof of Concept	Months 1–6	London	30 barbers, 15 shops, first 100 bookings. Unit economics confirmed.
2 — UK Roll-Out	Months 7–18	Manchester, Birmingham, Leeds, Glasgow	Stage 2 raise from London traction. Head of Growth hired.
3 — Ireland	Months 18–24	Dublin	Second jurisdiction. Enterprise Ireland routes open.
4 — International	Years 3–4	Australia, US, Japan	Founder's existing network. Series A raise.

Why Haatch

Haatch backs AI-driven businesses at the earliest stage, and BarberRepublic is AI-native at its core — the intelligence layer is the product, not a feature. The raise sits within Haatch's cheque size, the market is validated,

and the founding team combines deep industry authority with world-class AI architecture. We would welcome the opportunity to take Haatch through the full model and answer any questions directly.

Contact: Johnny Shanahan, Founder | Introduction via Graham Byrne.